

Dhāraṇī of the Noble Avalokiteśvara, Endowed with Great Compassion

Āryāvalokiteśvara-mahākaruṇā-dhāraṇī · Toh 711 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་སྐྱ་རས་གཟགས་སྟི་རྗེ་པ་དྲ་ལྷ་པའ་གི་བྱུངས།

Toh 711 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in Tibetan as beginning with homage to the noble Avalokiteśvara endowed with great compassion, and it belongs to the broad category of dhāraṇī and ritual literature within the Kangyur's collection of spells and protective formulas. The text presents a short dhāraṇī mantra associated with Avalokiteśvara, the great bodhisattva of compassion, and includes brief ritual instructions directing the practitioner to recite the formula seven times over a twig of the apāmārga plant across seven days. It is a compact, practical scripture focused on the recitation and application of a specific dhāraṇī for purification and the fulfillment of aspirations. The text follows immediately after the preceding dhāraṇī called "Becoming Empty," suggesting it belongs to a series of related dhāraṇī texts gathered together in this section of the Kangyur.

immeasurable benefits arise. The dhāraṇī called "Becoming Empty" is complete.

Homage to the Three Jewels. Homage to the great bodhisattva, the noble Avalokiteśvara, endowed with great compassion.

Tadyathā: avalokini, valokini, prabhālokini, jīvahaparishodhani, dhidaniyagame, āśāparishodhani, sarvasatvāmanorthe, kāyasiddhe, śūtīdhāraṇī, smṛtidhāraṇī, svāhā.

According to the ritual, for seven days, recite seven times over a twig of the apāmārga plant —

Translator's Notes

- The mantra syllables are transliterated from Sanskrit-derived phonetic Tibetan and are rendered as closely as possible to their reconstructed Sanskrit forms. Some syllables resist full reconstruction; the rendering given follows standard dhāraṇī convention. The phrase "Becoming Empty" (འདྲ་ལྷ་པའ་གི་བྱུངས།) as the name of the dhāraṇī is a literal rendering; it may refer to a text titled "Śūnyatāpariṇāma" or similar, though no Sanskrit witness is cited in the passage.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.